



Figure 6 | Fixed-marker age differences depend on resident population and sampled sex composition.

Rationale: A shared ageing mechanism would require more than a similar marker direction across organs. Distinct resident-cell identities, assay differences and unequal sex composition can produce apparent agreement or disagreement.

A-B, 24-minus-3-month differences in equal-mouse detection fractions for a fixed marker subset, using all observed sexes and then males only. Values are percentage points; n labels give young/old mouse counts. The complete predeclared marker family remains in the source table. These are separate within-population descriptions, not a pooled cross-organ model.

Results: In the all-sex summaries, Il1b detection changes by −2.3, +6.2 and −5.0 percentage points in brain microglia, lung macrophages and kidney macrophages, respectively. The kidney estimate changes to +2.2 points in males alone. Several other marker magnitudes also depend on the sampled sex composition. Sparse populations, different assays and reused mice limit interpretation. The old female stratum is absent, so these sensitivity panels do not test an age-by-sex interaction; shared directions would not by themselves establish a conserved ageing programme.